

## X13 B FAIR LABOR IN BUILDING PRODUCTS | O (MAX : 3 PT )

**Intent :** Accelerate the elimination of modern slavery by selecting building products from manufacturers that advance and verify fair labor rights across their facilities and in their supply chains.

**Summary :** This WELL feature requires the selection of building products from manufacturers that verify that fair labor practices are implemented at their manufacturing facilities and across their supply chains.

**Solutions :** Around the globe, people are tricked or forced into exploitative situations that they cannot refuse or leave, suffering what is collectively known as modern slavery conditions.<sup>1</sup> Not counting commercial sexual exploitation, an estimated 21.2 million people (of which 13 million were children) were subject to forced labor exploitation in 2021.<sup>2</sup> Products used in the construction of real estate are significant contributors to this problem.<sup>3</sup> Due to the complexity and obscurity of supply chains, it can be nearly impossible to identify products and materials that are "slavery-free."<sup>3</sup>

**Impact :** Creating demand for "slavery-free" products, in addition to aiding in the elimination of forced labor and the worst forms of child labor, can steer the market towards making fair labor practices the baseline across the building products industry.<sup>3</sup> As one of the main contributors of decent work,<sup>4</sup> provision of a living wage is likely to improve workers' physical and mental health and has the potential of breaking the poverty cycle.<sup>5</sup> Going deeper into the supply chain, several certification bodies assess and certify good labor practices during the extraction and processing of common raw building materials such as cement, steel and copper. Finally, companies can assess labor conditions within their own facilities and across their own supply chains through third-party audits and/or the achievement of relevant certifications.

### PART 1 SELECT PRODUCTS FROM MANUFACTURERS THAT PROVIDE LIVING WAGES (MAX : 1 PT )

*For All Spaces:*

For at least five manufacturers of products from the product classes listed in Appendix X1, one the following is provided:

- a. Manufacturer's proof of accreditation provided by one of the following organizations:
  1. SAI (Social Accountability International) [Reference](#), administered by Social Accountability Accreditation Services (SAAS).<sup>6</sup>
  2. Any certification from the [Reference](#).<sup>7</sup>
  3. A living wage certification from a member of the [Reference](#).<sup>8</sup>
- b. Manufacturer's public statement disclosing the living wage provision that includes the following:
  1. How a living wage is provided to all people (including contractors) who work in the manufacturer's facilities.
  2. How the living wage is determined and regularly updated.
  3. How organization-wide compliance with the living wage provision is confirmed, including metrics used to measure compliance.

**Note :**

This feature is a beta strategy and has an additional documentation requirement (beta feature feedback form). The feedback form supports IWBI in developing new features that are effective and applicable to projects around the world.

### PART 2 SELECT PRODUCTS WITH CERTIFIED RAW MATERIALS (MAX : 1 PT )

*For All Spaces:*

For at least ten products from the product classes listed in Appendix X1, each made by a distinct manufacturer, one of the following is met:

- a. Has one of the following:
  1. A [Reference](#) with a Silver, Gold or Platinum Social Fairness level.<sup>9</sup>
  2. Any [Reference](#) that includes criteria for "Minimum Entitlement including Wages," "Workplace Health and Safety," and "Modern Slavery and Human Rights including Labor Rights".<sup>10</sup>
  3. A [Reference](#).<sup>11</sup>
- b. For products containing materials listed in Appendix X2, each of those materials (up to a maximum of five materials per product) meet one of the following:
  1. Is certified under one of the applicable standards listed in Appendix X2.
  2. Is supplied by a manufacturer that meets Part 1 of this feature.

**Note :**

This feature is a beta strategy and has an additional documentation requirement (beta feature feedback form). The feedback form supports IWBI in developing new features that are effective and applicable to projects around the world.

### PART 3 SELECT MANUFACTURERS WITH TRANSPARENCY IN SUPPLY CHAIN PRACTICES (MAX : 1 PT )

*For All Spaces:*

For at least five manufacturers of products from the product classes listed in Appendix X1, one of the following is met:

- a. The manufacturer is a Full Member of the [Reference](#).
- b. The manufacturer has made a public statement disclosing the following:
  1. Confirmation that at least five of the manufacturer's suppliers (or 5%, whichever is greater) have been assessed for labor conditions by third-party auditors.<sup>13,14</sup>
  2. Confirmation that the audits were based on semi-announced visits to the manufacturer's supplier facilities.<sup>15</sup>
  3. The audit criteria, sampling methodology and relevant metrics of compliance.
  4. Confirmation that the facilities were found in compliance with local regulation and the following principles:<sup>16</sup>
    1. Workers' freedom of movement.
    2. Workers' freedom of association and collective bargaining.
    3. Forced labor.
    4. Working hours and remuneration.
    5. Occupational health and safety.
    6. Worst forms of child labor.
    7. Sexual harassment.

**Note :**

This feature is a beta strategy and has an additional documentation requirement (beta feature feedback form). The feedback form supports IWBI in developing new features that are effective and applicable to projects around the world.

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## APPENDIX X1:

The following denominations for product classes apply throughout the Materials concept:

1. Millwork and fixtures: Built-in cabinetry/ bespoke joinery, countertops, window treatments (e.g., curtains, blinds) and window films. Does not include beddings, pillows, artwork, rugs and appliances.
2. Ceiling and wall finishes: Ceiling and wall planks and tiles, acoustical treatments, wall bases and wallcoverings including wallpaper.
3. Electrical and electronic products: Cables, electrical boxes; tubing and conduit; fire alarm notification and initiating devices (e.g., strobes, pull stations); environmental, HVAC, occupancy and motion sensors and meters; and relays, thermostats and load break switches.
4. Flooring: Carpeting, resilient flooring (e.g., sheet, tiles) and any other natural or engineered floor covering product, including finished poured flooring.
5. Furniture: Movable objects intended to support various human activities such as seating (e.g., chairs, stools, sofas), eating or working (e.g., tables, desks, workstations), and sleeping (e.g., beds). Also includes objects for holding and storage such as chests, shelves, bookcases, file cabinets and cabinetry (except custom-made or built-in), and space separations such as freestanding partition panels.
6. Interior doors and windows, including door casings.
7. Insulation: Thermal and acoustic insulation in walls and ceilings. Unless explicitly stated, this class excludes duct, tube and pipe insulation.
8. Wet-applied products: Paints, adhesives, sealants, coatings and finished poured flooring.
9. Demountable Wall Partitions: Permanently installed wall systems that are designed to be relocated without damage to the product.

## APPENDIX X2:

The table below lists eligible certifications by type of material.

| Material                 | Relevant Certifications                                                         | Scope*                                                |
|--------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| Copper                   | <a href="#">The Copper Mark Certification</a>                                   | Upstream supply chain                                 |
|                          | <a href="#">Responsible Mineral Initiative</a>                                  | Product and Upstream supply chain                     |
|                          | <a href="#">LME (London Metal Exchange) Responsible Sourcing</a>                | Extracting/Farming                                    |
|                          | <a href="#">Initiative for Responsible Mining Assurance Standard</a>            | Extracting/Farming                                    |
| Steel and Iron           | <a href="#">LME (London Metal Exchange) Responsible Sourcing</a>                | Extracting/Farming                                    |
|                          | <a href="#">Responsible Minerals Initiative</a>                                 | Product and Upstream supply chain                     |
|                          | <a href="#">Responsible Steel Certification</a>                                 | Product and Upstream supply chain                     |
| Aluminum                 | <a href="#">Aluminum Stewardship Initiative (ASI) Chain of Custody Standard</a> | Product                                               |
|                          | <a href="#">Aluminum Stewardship Initiative (ASI) Performance Standard</a>      | Upstream supply chain                                 |
|                          | <a href="#">Ethical Stone Register</a>                                          | Upstream supply chain                                 |
| Stone                    | <a href="#">Fair Stone Standard</a>                                             | Upstream supply chain                                 |
|                          | <a href="#">XertifiX Standard-Label</a>                                         | Extracting/Farming and Upstream supply chain          |
|                          | <a href="#">Initiative for Responsible Mining Assurance Standard</a>            | Extracting/Farming                                    |
| Mica, Gypsum, and Silica | <a href="#">Responsible Mica Initiative</a>                                     | Extracting/Farming and Upstream supply chain          |
|                          | <a href="#">Responsible Minerals Initiative (conformant facilities)</a>         | Product and Upstream supply chain                     |
| Concrete                 | <a href="#">Concrete Sustainability Council Certification</a>                   | Product and Upstream supply chain                     |
|                          | <a href="#">American Tree Farm System (ATFS)</a>                                | Upstream supply chain                                 |
|                          | <a href="#">Programme for the Endorsement of Forest Certification (PEFC)</a>    | Extracting/Farming and Upstream supply chain          |
| Timber                   | <a href="#">Sustainable Forestry Initiative (SFI)</a>                           | Product, Upstream supply chain and Extracting/Farming |
|                          | <a href="#">Forest Stewardship Council (FSC) Chain of Custody Certification</a> | Product, Upstream supply chain and Extracting/Farming |
|                          | <a href="#">Better Cotton</a>                                                   | Product and Extracting/Farming                        |
|                          | <a href="#">Fairtrade Cotton Mark</a>                                           | Product and Upstream supply chain                     |
|                          | <a href="#">Fairtrade Textile Standard</a>                                      | Product and Upstream supply chain                     |
| Textiles                 | <a href="#">FSC Certified Viscose</a>                                           | Product, Upstream supply chain and Extracting/Farming |
|                          | <a href="#">Global Organic Textile Standard</a>                                 | Product and Upstream supply chain                     |
|                          | <a href="#">Good Weave</a>                                                      | Product and Upstream supply chain                     |
|                          | <a href="#">Responsible Wool Standard</a>                                       | Extracting/Farming                                    |
|                          | <a href="#">STeP by Oeko-Tex</a>                                                | Upstream supply chain                                 |
|                          | <a href="#">Global Recycle Standard</a>                                         | Product and Upstream supply chain                     |
| Leather                  | <a href="#">STeP by Oeko-Tex</a>                                                | Upstream supply chain                                 |

\*Certifications may be of the following scope

Product: voluntary standards established by independent, third-party groups relating to environmental, social, ethical, and product safety issues. These groups incur the cost and responsibility of certifying that products adhere to their standards and award a certification seal, or logo, that proves compliance.